Read Words in Context

READ!

Venice: City of Many Boats

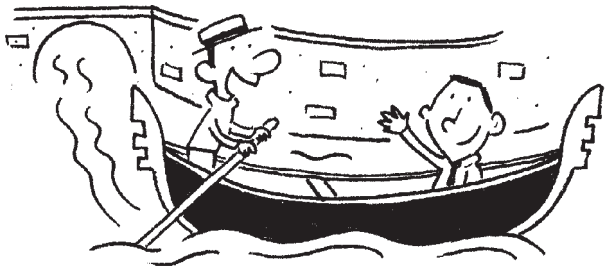
Venice, Italy, is made up of 117 small islands that sit in a lagoon. It is an **impressive** city because of its extraordinary canals and majestic buildings. Many people visit it each year and are dazzled by its amazing places.

People get around in Venice with water taxis and special boats called "gondolas." The gondolas are **suitable** for Venice. Because they are long and narrow, they can get through Venice's many narrow waterways.

When I am in Venice, one of my favorite activities is to sit **casually** in a gondola as it moves slowly along the Grand Canal, and the many smaller canals. Doing this allows me to truly enjoy the scenery. I love to watch the boatmen, who guide the boats through the canals with great **dignity**. They are given honor and respect because of their impressive skills. Afterwards, I can **vividly** recall the sound of the gondoliers singing as they row. The memory of them remains clear in my mind.

There are many small boats on the canal, as well as **gigantic** barges. The barges have to be enormous because they carry fruits, vegetables, and other items that merchants sell. Since there is a lot of boat traffic on the canals, the boatmen must have a lot of **patience**, especially during traffic jams! Usually, they remain calm and don't get upset as they steer their boats through the waterways. The main reason there is so much boat traffic is that there aren't any cars or other motor vehicles in Venice!

But Venice has a big problem. It is sinking, and some scientists are afraid it will **perish** and disappear into the sea. Scientists from around the world are working together to keep it afloat. People who live in Venice try to **reassure** each other that the city will always be safe. The Venetians remain hopeful and continue to **thrive** and do well in their beautiful city.



Vocabulary Words

casually	**perish**
dignity	**reassure**
gigantic	**suitable**
impressive	**thrive**
patience	**vividly**

Word Learning Tip!

In this chapter, you have learned to use nouns, verbs, adjectives, adverbs, synonyms, and antonyms to determine what a word means. In this lesson, you will have a chance to use all of this information to find the meaning of unknown words.

Vocabulary Building Strategy

Use Context Clues You can often understand words you don't know by using the words and phrases around them. As you have learned, this is called the word's context. Using context clues helps you to know what a word means.

Powerful Vocabulary for Reading Success: Grade 5 © Scholastic Teaching Resources

Connect Words and Meanings

casually	**gigantic**	**patience**	**reassure**	**thrive**
dignity	**impressive**	**perish**	**suitable**	**vividly**

Directions Read each definition below. For each item, circle the letter of the word that matches the definition. You may use the glossary or a dictionary to help you.

1. to do well; to flourish or prosper
A. thrive **B.** reassure **C.** perish

2. having a strong or striking effect
A. impressive **B.** patience **C.** dignity

3. clearly or distinctly
A. vividly **B.** casually **C.** suitable

4. the ability to remain calm and not be hasty
A. perish **B.** thrive **C.** patience

5. a quality that makes someone worthy of honor and respect
A. gigantic **B.** patience **C.** dignity

6. right for a particular purpose or occasion
A. impressive **B.** suitable **C.** gigantic

7. in a way that is not planned or not formal
A. suitable **B.** vividly **C.** casually

8. huge; very large; enormous
A. patience **B.** gigantic **C.** suitable

9. spoil; to be destroyed before its time
A. perish **B.** reassure **C.** thrive

10. to calm; to give confidence or courage
A. reassure **B.** dignity **C.** perish



Continued on next page

Powerful Vocabulary for Reading Success: Grade 5 © Scholastic Teaching Resources

Connect More Words and Meanings

casually	**gigantic**	**patience**	**reassure**	**thrive**
dignity	**impressive**	**perish**	**suitable**	**vividly**

Directions Read each definition. Write the vocabulary word that fits in the blank.

11. **Definition:** right for a particular purpose or occasion
Smart travelers pack _____ clothing that is comfortable for long trips.

12. **Definition:** spoil; to be destroyed before its time
Don't take food that can _____ and spoil in your backpack.

13. **Definition:** to do well; to flourish or prosper
Many people _____ when they travel because they like to learn about new places.

14. **Definition:** to calm; to give confidence or courage
Be sure to _____ family members by sending postcards!
This will make them feel secure that you are safe and having a good time.

15. **Definition:** in a way that is not planned or not formal
It's nice to dress _____ when walking around the city and visiting museums.

16. **Definition:** having a strong or striking effect
There are many wonderful and _____ places to visit, especially in your own state!

17. **Definition:** huge; very large; enormous
Don't take a _____ suitcase because it will be too difficult to carry.

18. **Definition:** clearly or distinctly
Lucy _____ remembers every exciting detail of her trip to Yosemite National Park.

Write a Letter Imagine that you are going on a trip to your favorite city. Which city is it? Write a letter to the Tourist Bureau to get information about the city. Ask at least five questions in your letter and use five vocabulary words.

Powerful Vocabulary for Reading Success: Grade 5 © Scholastic Teaching Resources

Use Words in Context

casually	**gigantic**	**patience**	**reassure**	**thrive**
dignity	**impressive**	**perish**	**suitable**	**vividly**

Directions Use the word in boldface to help you complete each item. Write your answers in the blanks.

Name two activities that you need **patience** to do well.

1. _____ **2.** _____

Name two foods that can **perish** if they are not in the refrigerator.

3. _____ **4.** _____

Name two things that **thrive** when it rains.

5. _____ **6.** _____

Name two clothing items that are **suitable** to take on a vacation to the mountains.

7. _____ **8.** _____

Name two books that you remember **vividly**.

9. _____ **10.** _____

Name two people who are **impressive** because they have done great things.

11. _____ **12.** _____

Name two people who have great **dignity**.

13. _____ **14.** _____

Name two places where you might see **gigantic** buildings.

15. _____ **16.** _____

Guess the Mystery Place Think of a place that everyone in class knows. Don't name it! Have a classmate write questions to ask you about the place. Your classmate should then ask you these questions until he or she guesses the place. Then switch roles, write questions about your classmate's place, and ask them. In your questions, use at least two vocabulary words on this list and three verbs from Lesson 2.

Powerful Vocabulary for Reading Success: Grade 5 © Scholastic Teaching Resources

Put Words Into Action

casually	**gigantic**	**patience**	**reassure**	**thrive**
dignity	**impressive**	**perish**	**suitable**	**vividly**

Directions Use the questions in each card to interview each word. Write the answers in the blanks.

Dignity

1. What do you mean?

_____

2. What words are your opposites?

_____

3. What part of speech are you?

_____

4. How could I use you in a sentence?

_____

_____

_____

5. What other word or words are in your "family"?

_____

_____

Thrive

6. What do you mean?

_____

7. What words are your opposites?

_____

8. What part of speech are you?

_____

9. How could I use you in a sentence?

_____

_____

_____

10. What is your past tense?

_____

Stage a Newscast With a group of classmates, plan and rehearse a TV newscast. One of you will write a speech as if he or she is a famous person, using all the vocabulary words. Everyone else will write questions to ask this person. These questions should contain all the words in this lesson.

Powerful Vocabulary for Reading Success: Grade 5 © Scholastic Teaching Resources

Review and Extend

casually	**gigantic**	**patience**	**reassure**	**thrive**
dignity	**impressive**	**perish**	**suitable**	**vividly**

Learn More!

Knowing a word's part of speech can help you use the word correctly when you speak and write. Seeing how a word is used in context can help you identify its part of speech.

noun
His *patience* was amazing.

verb
Birds *thrive* in that forest.

adjective
What a *gigantic* fish!

adverb
They walked *casually* through the old streets.

Directions Use the boldface word or phrase to help you determine which vocabulary word to use in each sentence. Write the answer in the blank. Then decide which part of speech the vocabulary word is and circle your choice.

	Part of Speech	
1. Glassblowers **clearly** and _____ imagine how an object will look as they blow the glass.	**2.** adjective	adverb
3. Venice has an _____ and **grand** history of glassblowing.	**4.** adjective	noun
5. Glass-makers used to _____ and **prosper** because their glass was highly prized throughout Europe.	**6.** noun	verb
7. The glass is _____ for vases and statues. It is **appropriate** and **fitting** for these items.	**8.** adverb	adjective
9. To _____ and **comfort** people that Venice was safe from fires in the glassworks, the factories were moved to the island of Murano a long time ago.	**10.** verb	adjective

Write About What Was Impressive Think of the most impressive event that you've seen. Write a few sentences about why you think it has left a lasting impression on you. Use at least two vocabulary words and three adjectives from Lesson 4 in your description.

Powerful Vocabulary for Reading Success: Grade 5 © Scholastic Teaching Resources

Check Your Mastery

Directions Complete each analogy. Write the word that best fits in the blank.

1. **Prosper** is to **flourish** as **succeed** is to _____
   dignity thrive vividly

2. **Tiny** is to **huge** as **small** is to _____
   gigantic patience impressive

3. **Rot** is to **spoil** as **decay** is to _____
   impressive perish patience

4. **Correct** is to **proper** as **fitting** is to _____
   vividly suitable dignity

5. **Comfort** is to **support** as **encourage** is to _____
   vividly casually reassure

Directions Circle the letter of each correct answer.

6. Which of the following people is dressed **casually**?
   A. a boy wearing shorts and a tee-shirt
   B. a soldier wearing a dress uniform
   C. a woman wearing a business suit
   D. a man wearing a shirt and tie

7. Which of the following would you find **impressive** and grand?
   A. the pyramids
   B. a squished sandwich
   C. a mud puddle
   D. a trash basket

8. A person who stays calm and has a lot of **patience** would most likely—
   A. get tense when things go wrong.
   B. not be good to have in an emergency.
   C. stay relaxed even when things get busy.
   D. start yelling when upset.

9. A person who **vividly** remembers a vacation—
   A. forgets the vacation.
   B. remembers what happened during a vacation.
   C. doesn't care about it.
   D. talks about going on vacation.

10. A person who has **dignity** and acts with self-respect—
    A. travels around America.
    B. is polite and kind to other people.
    C. plays basketball.
    D. is impatient with other people.

Powerful Vocabulary for Reading Success: Grade 5 © Scholastic Teaching Resources